

Fly GACA — Monetization Strategy

SECTION 03-finance

TYPE strategy

STATUS **active**

OWNER Founder

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Status: **adopted June 2026**. This document is the single source of truth for pricing and the revenue plan. `pricing.html`, `schools.html`, `flygaca.html`, `assets/js/pricing-toggle.js` and the ROADMAP Phase 5 price sheet must match the price card below. The companion operational playbook for the B2B motion is `docs/b2b-pipeline.md`.

Where we are

The site is in **launch mode** — **everything is free for everyone** (`window.FG_LAUNCH_MODE = true` in `assets/js/entitlements.js`, `ADEL_LAUNCH_MODE=free` in `functions/.env.flygaca-app`). The entire billing machine is built and dormant: Stripe checkout (`functions/stripe.js`), RevenueCat iOS IAP (`functions/revenuecatWebhook.js`), B2B seat licences (`functions/school.js`), the Captain Adel free-tier quota (`functions/rag/dailyquota.js`), and the protected-content gate (`functions/content.js`).

Online checkout cannot open until the legal entity exists (ROADMAP P0-3). Schools, however, can be quoted and invoiced manually today — so the revenue plan is sequenced B2B-first.

Guiding rule — never paywall the regulations

Unchanged and non-negotiable: the GACAR library, the guides and the safety lessons stay free forever. They are the SEO funnel, the trust-builder and the safest legal posture. Fly GACA charges for the **tools, teaching and AI** that act on the regulations — never for reading the law.

Market benchmarks (June 2026)

Prices observed for comparable products (1 USD $\approx$ 3.75 SAR):

Comparable	Price	$\approx$ SAR
Boldmethod (study subscription)	\$14.99/mo	~56/mo
ChatGPT Plus (AI-tutor WTP anchor)	\$20/mo	~75/mo
Bristol Groundschool question bank	€31/mo	~135/mo
ATPL Training (QB + AI tutor)	from €9.90/mo	~43/mo
Gleim FAA test-prep bundle	\$49–99 one-time	185–370
ASA Prepware (per test)	\$59–69 one-time	220–260

Comparable	Price	≈ SAR
King Schools / Sporty's course	\$179–349 one-time	670–1,310
ForeFlight Basic/Pro/Performance	\$120/\$240/\$360 per yr	450/900/1,350 per yr
CPL at OxfordSaudia (context, not a competitor)	—	~120,000 total

The economics that matter: a Saudi cadet spends ~SAR 120,000+ on a CPL. A failed written exam or a delayed checkride costs more than a year of any study tool. Willingness to pay is anchored by the global study-subscription band (Boldmethod/ChatGPT ≈ SAR 55–75/mo), not by the cost of the content.

Price card (SAR) — the decided numbers

Subscriptions

Item	Price	Why
Pro Monthly	59/mo	Boldmethod band, under the ChatGPT-Plus anchor. The monthly is the anchor, not the product.
Pro Annual	349/yr (≈29/mo, save 51%)	Pulls cash forward, locks a training year, undercuts ForeFlight Basic, costs less than two Exam Terms. Headline framed as ~SAR 29/month on marketing surfaces. 7-day free trial.
Exam Term	199 one-time, 120 days	Gleim/ASA per-test band. Deliberately priced so the annual is the obvious upgrade for anyone with more than one exam ahead.

Prep Packs (one-time; official GACA/testing fees never included)

Item	Price	Why
License Conversion Prep Pack	899 (launch 699) · incl. 90 days Pro	Top of the King/Sporty's course band. Conversion candidates are employment-gated — the highest-WTP segment on the site.
ELPT / SAELPT Prep Pack	349 · incl. 30 days Pro	Right vs. one-time test-prep comparables.
AIP Prep Pack	299 · incl. 30 days Pro	Entry pack; feeds the funnel.
Conversion Bundle (all three)	1,299 (saves 248)	~16% bundle discount after the pack raise.
Captain Adel 1:1 Consult (180 min)	899 (launch 699)	Founder time is the scarcest input; the launch discount narrows from 599 → 699.
Conversion Pack Premium	1,699	Pack + consult + 6 months Pro; priced to keep the consult's value intact.

Fly GACA for Schools (B2B) — annual, per seat, minimum 10 seats

Seats	Price/seat/yr	Why
10–24	299	14% under consumer annual; includes the admin dashboard.
25–74	249	29% volume discount.
75+	199	The anchor for academy-scale deals.
Founding partner (first 2–3 schools only)	199 flat, year 1	In exchange for a logo, a case study and a feedback loop.

Every pack bundles Pro days **by design** — services feed the subscription. The free tier (post-launch-mode) stays: library free forever, **5 Captain Adel questions/month**, 3 tool runs/day, all guides free.

The plan — three phases

Phase A — B2B now (the only invoice-able revenue)

Schools don't need Stripe. The flow exists end-to-end today:

1. Outreach to GACAR Part 141 academies and operators (target list and sequence in `docs/b2b-pipeline.md`).
2. Quote per the seat card above; founding-partner rate for the first 2–3.
3. Signed order → manual ZATCA-compliant e-invoice → bank transfer.
4. Grant access with the existing admin callable: `grantSchoolLicence(emails, schoolId, expiresAt)` (`functions/school.js`).
5. Run the customer-success lifecycle (onboarding → health → renewal) using the playbooks already in `docs/`.

Year-1 revenue logic: 10 schools × ~50 seats × ~SAR 249 ≈ **SAR 125k ARR** — this dominates everything else until consumer checkout opens, so it gets the selling time.

Phase B — consumer pre-launch (checkout still blocked)

Keep launch mode ON, but stop giving it away silently — make the free period a **founding-member campaign**:

- Reframe the launch banner: free during launch, and joining the waitlist locks **founding-member annual at SAR 299** for the first year (first 500 members).
- Communicate the post-launch free tier *now* (library always free, 5 Adel questions/month, 3 tools/day) so the flip surprises nobody.
- Instrument what free users actually use (Adel volume, tool opens, study starts) — these numbers set the day-one conversion targets.
- Lead magnets stay free by design: Conversion Eligibility Checker, ELP Readiness Self-Check, AIP Quiz — each one ends in the matching pack CTA.

Phase C — the paywall flip (entity + Stripe live)

Activation checklist, in order:

1. **Stripe live:** create the products at the price card above; set `STRIPE_PRICE_MONTHLY` / `STRIPE_PRICE_ANNUAL` secrets; verify `createCheckoutSession` + `stripeWebhook` end-to-end in test mode.
2. **Gate Captain Adel first** (it is the marginal-cost item): remove `ADEL_LAUNCH_MODE=free` from `functions/.env.flygaca-app` and redeploy functions — the server quota (5/month, KSA month boundary) takes over.
3. **Flip the client:** set `window.FG_LAUNCH_MODE = false` in `assets/js/entitlements.js`; tool metering (3/day) and Study/logbook gating resume. Bump `sw.js` version.
4. **Protected content:** move paid payloads (quiz banks, Ground School, pack content) into `functions/protected/`, set `ADEL_PROTECTED_CONTENT=1` per `office/runbook-security-rollout.md`.
5. **Grandfather window:** 30 days — every existing account gets the founding-member annual (SAR 299) offer by email before quotas bite. Honour every waitlist lock.
6. Remove the launch banner from `pricing.html`; switch JSON-LD offers from `PreOrder` to `InStock`.
7. iOS: mirror prices in RevenueCat products (`pack_aip`, `pack_elpt`, `pack_conversion`, monthly/annual subs).

Revenue mix to expect (and what to build/sell first)

1. **Schools** — dominant year 1; recurring, invoice-based, sticky. Sell now.
2. **Prep Packs** — high-ticket one-time; conversion candidates buy on need, not on habit. Build content depth here second.
3. **Pro subscriptions** — compounding but slow to start; the annual push + founding-member lock accelerates it.
4. **Exam Term** — seasonal; promote in the run-up to exam windows.
5. **Consults / Premium** — margin-rich but founder-time-bound; keep slots scarce, raise price before adding slots.

KPIs

- Waitlist size and weekly growth (pre-launch conversion pool)
- School seats sold / active vs. licensed seats (>80% adoption target — see `customer-success.md`)
- Captain Adel cost per free user per month (must stay below ~SAR 1)
- Free→paid conversion at the Adel quota wall (the single best conversion point)
- Annual share of new Pro subscriptions (target >60% — the toggle defaults to annual on purpose)

Invariants to preserve

- Entitlements are **server-only** (`firestore.rules`); nothing in this plan changes that. All grants flow through Cloud Functions.
- Every user-facing price string is bilingual (`data-en` / `data-ar`) — `npm run check:i18n` enforces it.
- PDPL: user questions are personal data; the assistant stays on the in-Kingdom region plan regardless of monetization phase.
- Not affiliated with GACA: packs sell **preparation**, never the licence, and official fees are always stated as excluded.